Cumulative Frequency

Exam code: 0607

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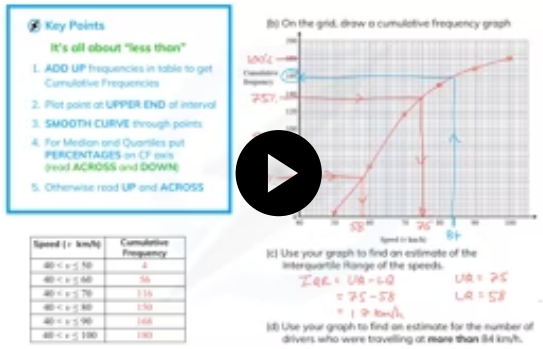

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Cumulative frequency

What is cumulative frequency?

- **Cumulative** refers to a "running total" or "adding up as you go along"
- So in a table of **grouped data**
  - **cumulative frequency** means all of the frequencies for the different groups totalled up to the **end** of the group in a given row

- When working out cumulative frequencies you may see **tables** presented in two ways
  - A regular grouped data table with an extra column for cumulative frequencies
    - E.g. rows labelled $0 \le x < 20$, $20 \le x < 40$, $40 \le x < 60$, etc

Group	Frequency	Cumulative frequency
$0 \le x < 20$	14	14
$20 \le x < 40$	25	39 (because 14+25=39)

Help me understand

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Got it

		14+25+29=68)
$60 \le x < 80$	12	80 (because 14+25+29+12=80)

- or a separate table where every group is relabelled as starting at the beginning (often zero)
  - E.g. rows labelled $0 \le x < 20$, $0 \le x < 40$, $0 \le x < 60$, etc.
  - Or $x < 20$, $x < 40$, $x < 60$, etc.

Group	Cumulative frequency
$0 \le x < 20$ (or $x < 20$)	14
$0 \le x < 40$ (or $x < 40$)	39
$0 \le x < 60$ (or $x < 60$)	68
$0 \le x < 80$ (or $x < 80$)	80

- In the second type of table, you can **subtract** to find the individual frequencies
  - E.g. the frequency of the $20 \le x < 40$ class interval is 39−14=25
  - The frequency of the $40 \le x < 60$ class interval is 68−39=29, etc.

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